CROSS-BORDER NOTES

A Uzbek bank just went on state television and said it is converting to Islamic finance.

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Sun Choi

On August 7, MKBANK told the briefing it is reforming its banking system and converting to Islamic finance, alongside domestic retail promotions.

Sun Choi

Banks don't reframe their operating model for a retail campaign. They do it when the regulator has signaled where capital is allowed to come from next.

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Gulf capital lands where the plumbing already exists. No sukuk desk, no murabaha structuring, no Islamic window: no serious GCC allocation.

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Sun Choi

Regulatory intent precedes capital. If Tashkent normalizes Islamic finance at the bank level, sovereign and quasi-sovereign issuance tends to follow, not lead.

> **Whoever converts first sets the terms for the capital that follows. Treat this like a central bank circular, not a press release.**

Sun Choi
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